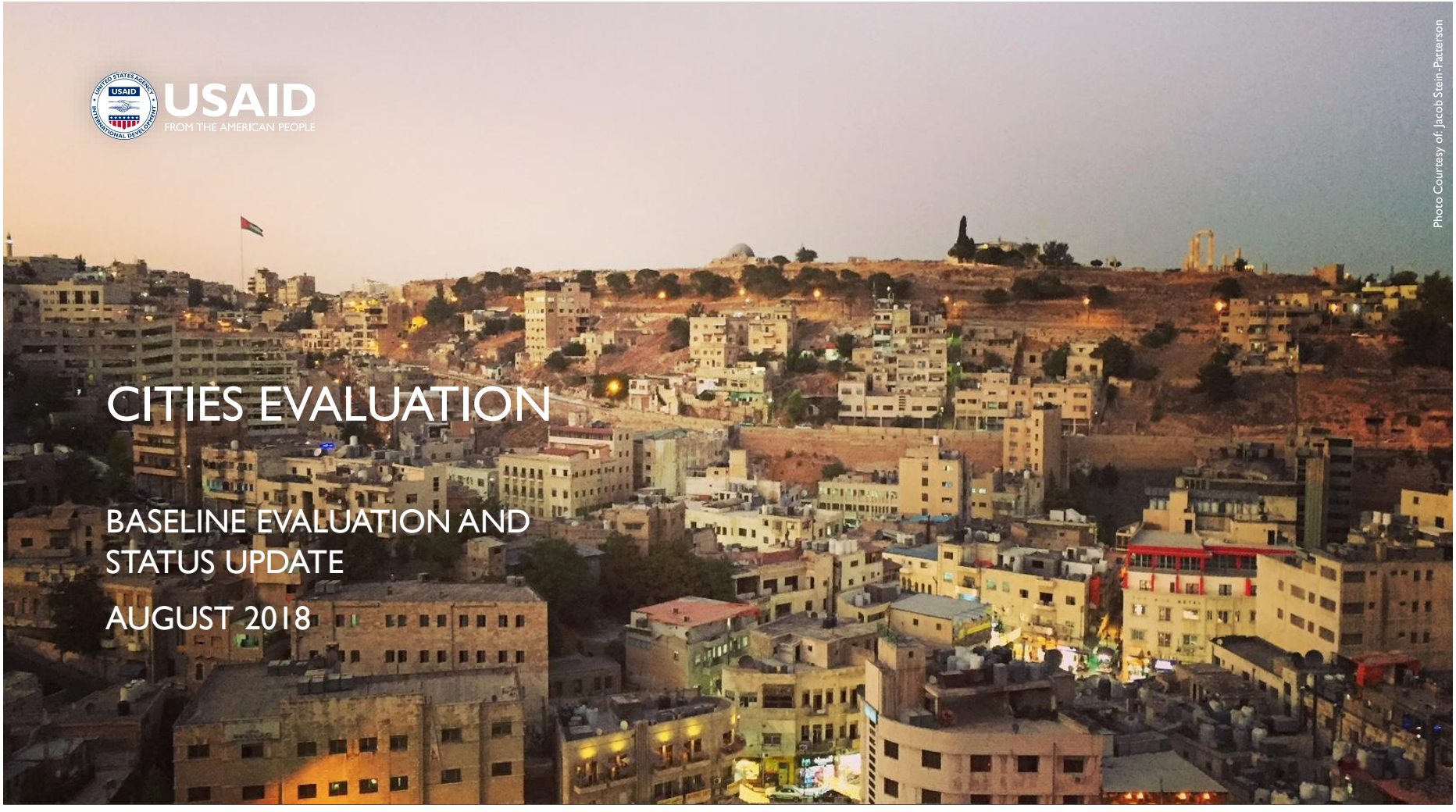

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CITIES EVALUATION
BASELINE EVALUATION AND STATUS UPDATE
AUGUST 2018
Photo Courtesy of: Jacob Stein-Patterson

CITIES Baseline Evaluation - Outline

- Background and purpose
- Evaluation design
- Baseline findings
- Final thoughts and next steps

Background and Purpose

Evaluation Timeline

- CITIES RFTOP (April 2016)
  - "An external quasi-experimental impact evaluation will be conducted of this program to measure improvements in municipal governance" [pg 22]

- Evaluability assessment (January 2017)
  - Estimating impact depended crucially on correctly identifying activity zones of influence
  - Any impact evaluation should focus on validating activity inputs and contributing to a learning agenda, not achieving external validity
  - In the event impact estimation not feasible, proceed with most feasibly rigorous design

Evaluation Timeline (cont.)

- October 2017
  - Subject matter expert assessments in municipal governance and decentralization
- February 2018
  - Evaluation Design Report approved
- March – May 2018
  - MICA data collection and scoring in 15 comparison municipalities, qualitative data collection

CITIES Timeline

- CITIES Year 1 / FY17: planning, negotiating with stakeholders, initial assessments
- CITIES Year 2 / FY18: continued assessments, initiation of some activities
- CITIES Year 3 / FY19: continued activities, grant fund disbursements (anticipated)

Evaluation Baseline Purpose

- A baseline evaluation report is the first assessment of an impact evaluation design against the reality of initial data collection
  - Evaluation data quality
  - Equivalency between treatment and comparison balance metrics
  - Initial validation or failure of assumptions
  - Further understanding and assessments of threats to validity of evaluation design and metrics

CITIES Baseline Evaluation: Objectives

- Internal validity of MICA measures
  - Did the evaluation team's MICA scoring in comparison municipalities produce internally valid measures?
  - If internally valid within the evaluation team, are they also internally valid (i.e. comparable) with CITIES MICA scoring?
- Baseline equivalency of MICA measures
  - Is there baseline equivalency between treatment and comparison municipalities?
  - At what level of MICA scoring?
  - What scoring areas showed the most equivalency? Which showed the most differences?
  - Are some observed differences considered more of a validity threat than others?

CITIES Baseline Evaluation: Objectives (cont.)

- Qualitative inquiry on status of municipal governance
  - What is the political economy of operations and relationships within municipalities? Between municipalities and governorates? Between municipalities and line ministries?
  - Are there any qualitative differences noticed between treatment and comparison municipalities?

- What is the current status of CITIES implementation? What has been observed about implementation fidelity, obstacles, and lessons learned?

Evaluation Design

Evaluation Questions

1. **What is the overall effectiveness of CITIES** for achieving its goals of enhancing democratic governance, improving trust and confidence in elected officials, and strengthening stability?

2. Which interventions under CITIES are **most likely to be sustained** over time?

3. **How well has CITIES developed synergies** (coordination and collaboration) with other USAID activities that focus on similar objectives, for example, decentralization and working with Municipalities? Are donors operating in the decentralization and local governance space achieving synergies through coordination or knowledge sharing?

4. Based on the performance of CITIES, both in terms of effectiveness and sustainability, **what are some key lessons learned**, by component and sub-activity?

Evaluation Activities and Data Streams

1. Replicate CITIES municipal institutional capacity measures (MICA) in 15 comparison municipalities

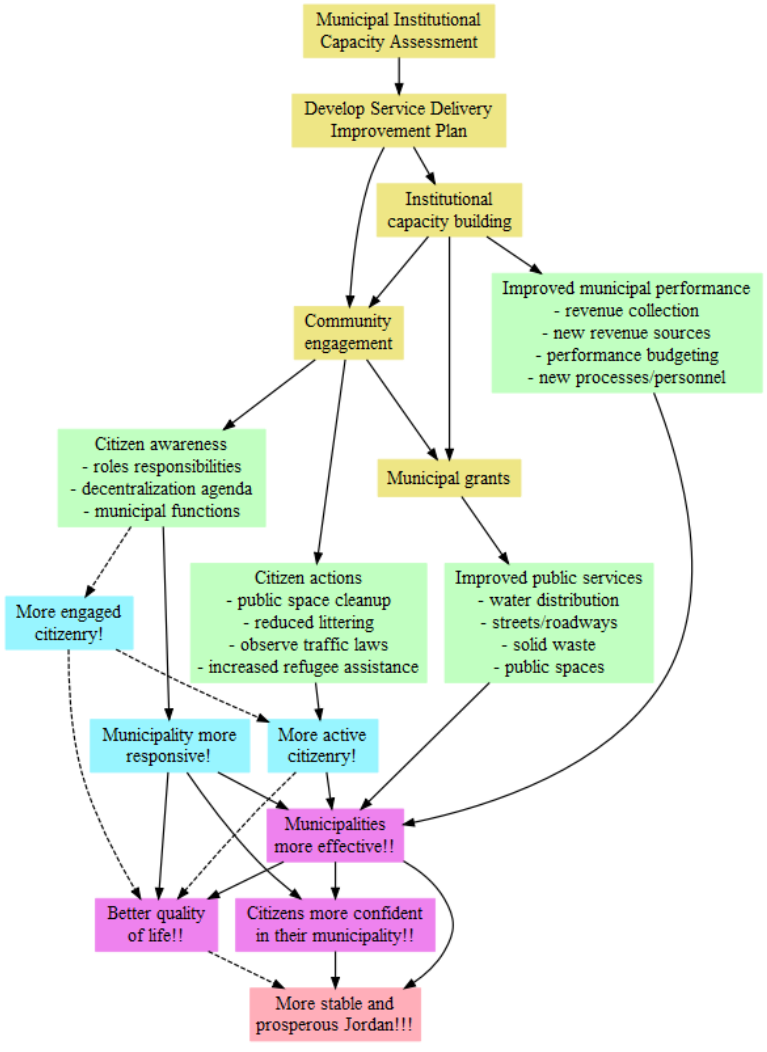
2. National household survey for public perception of municipal responsiveness and effectiveness

3. Qualitative data on local governance, decentralization, donor coordination

4. Track CITIES implementation fidelity and activity tracking

5. Small scale surveys targeting CITIES grants (future activity)

Evaluation Logic Model - Detailed Theory of Change



Evaluation Hypotheses and Indicators

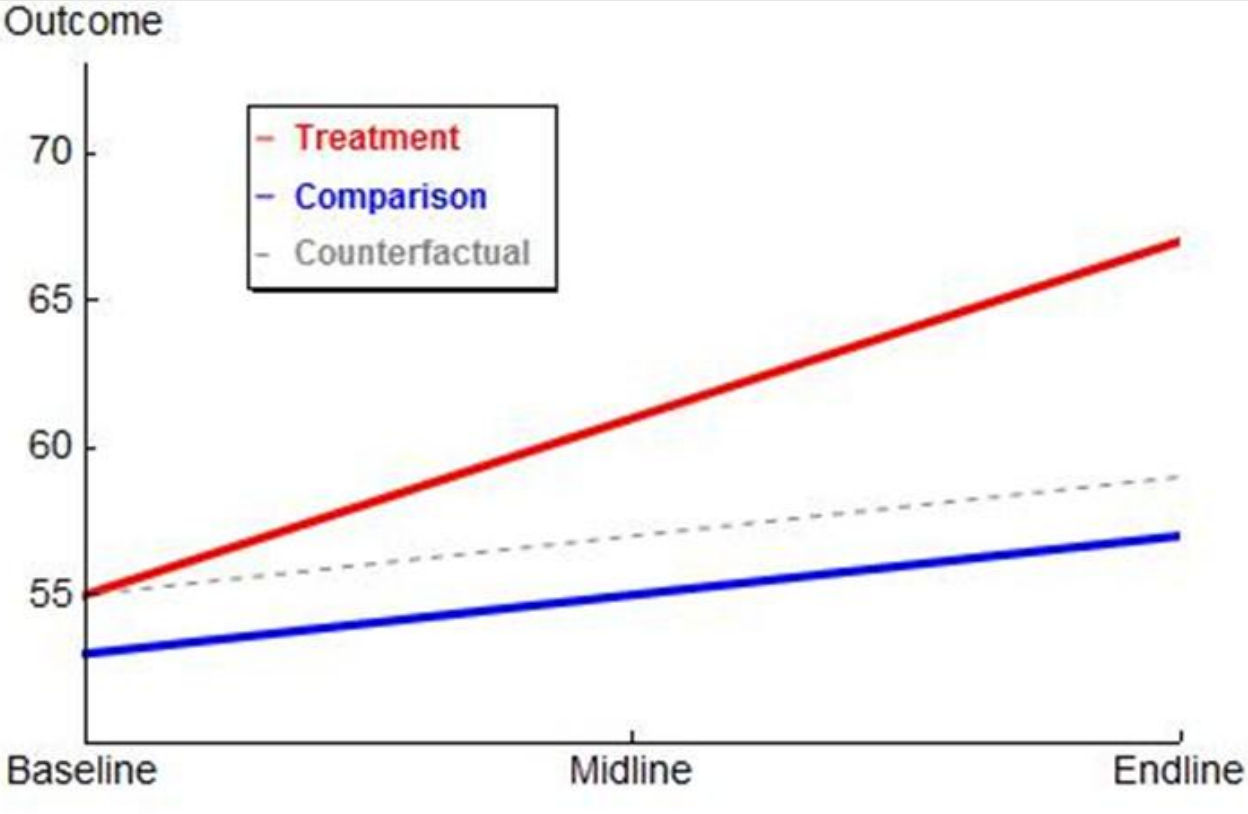
	Hypothesis	Indicators
1	If CITIES provides institutional capacity building, then municipal operations will improve.	- MICA Services Score - MICA GESI Score - Municipality Revenue - Budget allocation to salaries
2	If CITIES provides institutional capacity building, combined with incentive grants and improved public service delivery, then this will lead to an improvement in the quality of public services.	- Availability of services - Perceived quality/availability of services
3	If CITIES provides institutional capacity building, combined with proactive outreach by municipalities, then this will increase public perception that municipalities are responsive to citizen needs.	Perceived municipal responsiveness
4	If CITIES supports increased attention to marginalized groups, such as youth, gender, nationality, and disability, then this will strengthen a sense of community cohesion and resilience.	Perceived municipal effectiveness
5	If CITIES provides institutional capacity building, combined with proactive outreach and increased / improved public service delivery, then this will increase public perception that municipalities are effective.	Perceived ability to address common problems
6	More effective public service delivery, responsiveness to citizen needs, and strengthened community cohesion and resilience will increase citizen confidence in their municipality.	- Confidence in local government - Trust in local government
7	More effective public service delivery, confidence in local leadership and performance, and strengthened community cohesion and resilience will lead to a more stable and prosperous Jordan.	- Quality of life - Composite measures

Evaluation Strategy for Inference

- At the institutional / municipal level (MICA)
  - Difference-in-differences (d-i-d)
  - Looks only across treatment and comparison municipalities

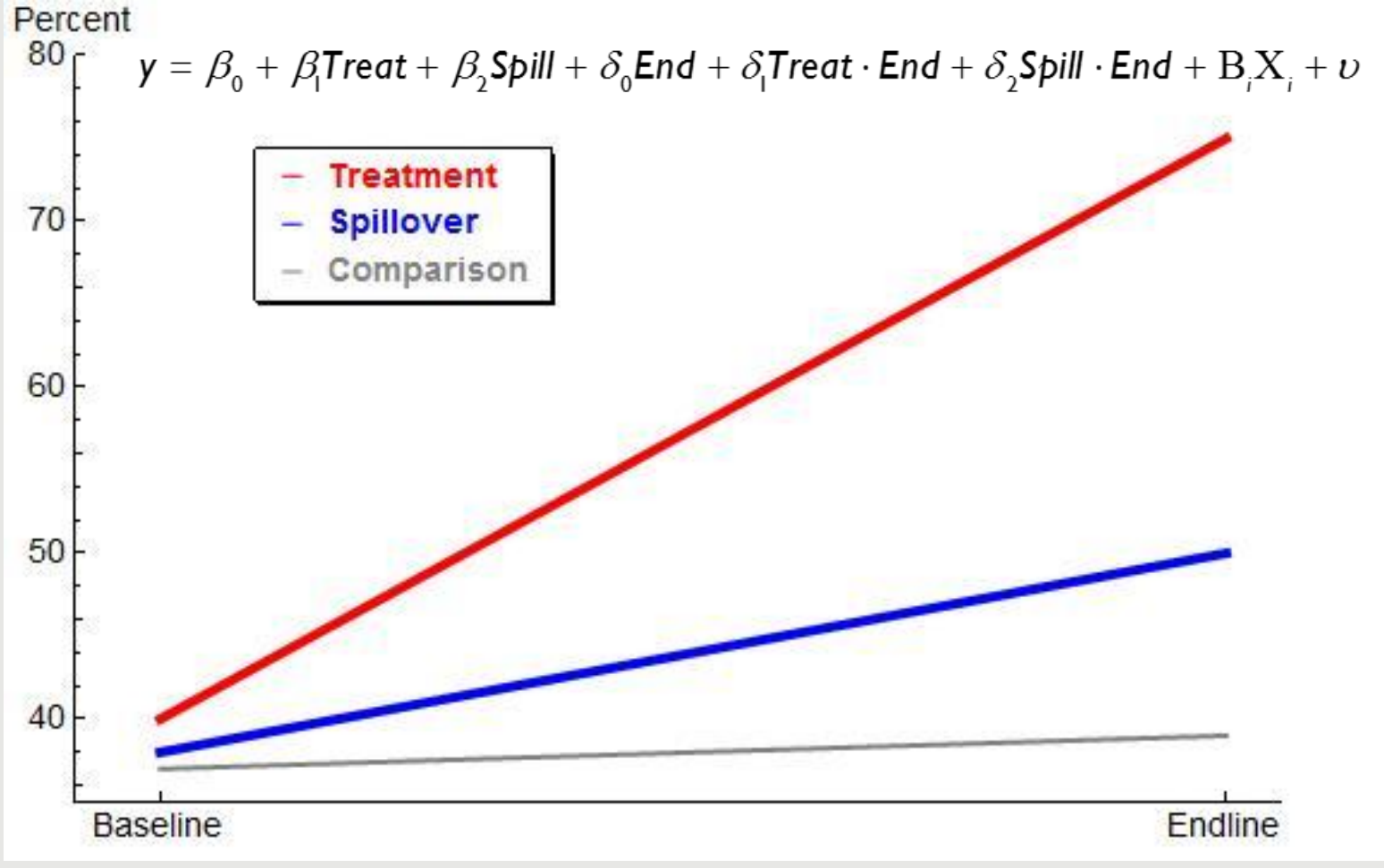
- At the citizen level (population survey)
  - Difference-in-differences with spillover group
  - Looks across treatment and comparison municipalities
  - Also compares direct, indirect, and non-beneficiaries in treatment municipalities

Difference in Differences (d-i-d)



$$y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 Treatment + \delta_0 Endline + \delta_1 Treatment \cdot Endline + \mathrm{B}_i \mathrm{X}_i + \upsilon$$

d-i-d with spillover group



Evaluation Strategy for Inference: Threats and Limitations

- Difference-in-difference estimates rely on two crucial assumptions
  - Treatment and comparison groups are equivalent prior to treatment
    - Was treatment randomly assigned?
    - If not, what selection effects were present during municipality selection?
  - Treatment and comparison groups would have equivalent responses to treatment
    - Could selection effects, in addition to creating differences between groups pre-treatment, indicate that the groups would have their own unique responses to the treatment?

Evaluation Strategy for Inference: Threats and Limitations

- Do we control for other USAID activities, other donor programming, GOJ programming?
- How does CITIES fit into the GOJ decentralization initiative?
- Validity of municipal institutional assessment measures (MICA) for purposes of impact evaluation an open question
- CITIES programming began in some municipalities prior to baseline measures – is this reconcilable?
- Some time elapsed between treatment MICA scoring and comparison MICA scoring – is this reconcilable?

Evaluation Strategy for Inference: Mitigation Strategies

- Propensity score matching to redress the lack of randomization
- Qualitative inquiry to understand context dynamics
  - Key informant interviews, relationship building, and relationship management
- Tracking contextual data where available
  - Government data, other donor presence and investments, decentralization progress
- Tracking CITIES activities
- Learning agenda
  - Triangulate multiple data sources to address broad questions about the implementation environment or differential treatment effects

Baseline Findings

- Findings from MICA scoring in 15 comparison municipalities
- Internal validity of MICA scoring
- Baseline equivalency across treatment and comparison MICA scores
- Other evaluation questions
- Status of CITIES implementation and activity tracking

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MICA Scoring and Supplementary Inquiry

Data collection

- MICA interviews in 15 comparison municipalities
- 22 supplementary KIIs to inform understanding of macro environment

Respondent Category	Total KIIs
Mayors	4
Municipal Council Members	2
Local Council Members	2
Governorate Council Members	2
Executive Council Members	2
CBOs	2
MoMA Officials	3
Donors	5
Total	22

Evaluation Question 1: Effectiveness

Themes:

- Municipal Services and Control
- Community Engagement within Municipalities
- Role of Local Councils
- Role of Governorate Councils
- Perceptions of Decentralization

Evaluation Question 1: Effectiveness

Municipal Services and Control

- Dysfunctional financial system
- Limited autonomy
- Weak institutional capacity and staffing challenges
- Expanding responsibilities and financial liabilities

Evaluation Question 1: Effectiveness

Community Engagement

- Engagement Channels
  - Direct contact
  - Social media
  - Local councils
  - Needs guide preparation process
- Limitations
  - Lack of systematic feedback or use of citizens input for planning
  - Fear of raising expectations

Evaluation Question 1: Effectiveness

Local Councils

- Unclear mandate and lack of resources
- Friction with municipal staff

Governorate Councils

- Limited mandate
- Limited devolution of power
- Lack of regulations
- Unsystematic interaction with municipal units
- Concern about community engagement

Evaluation Question 1: Effectiveness

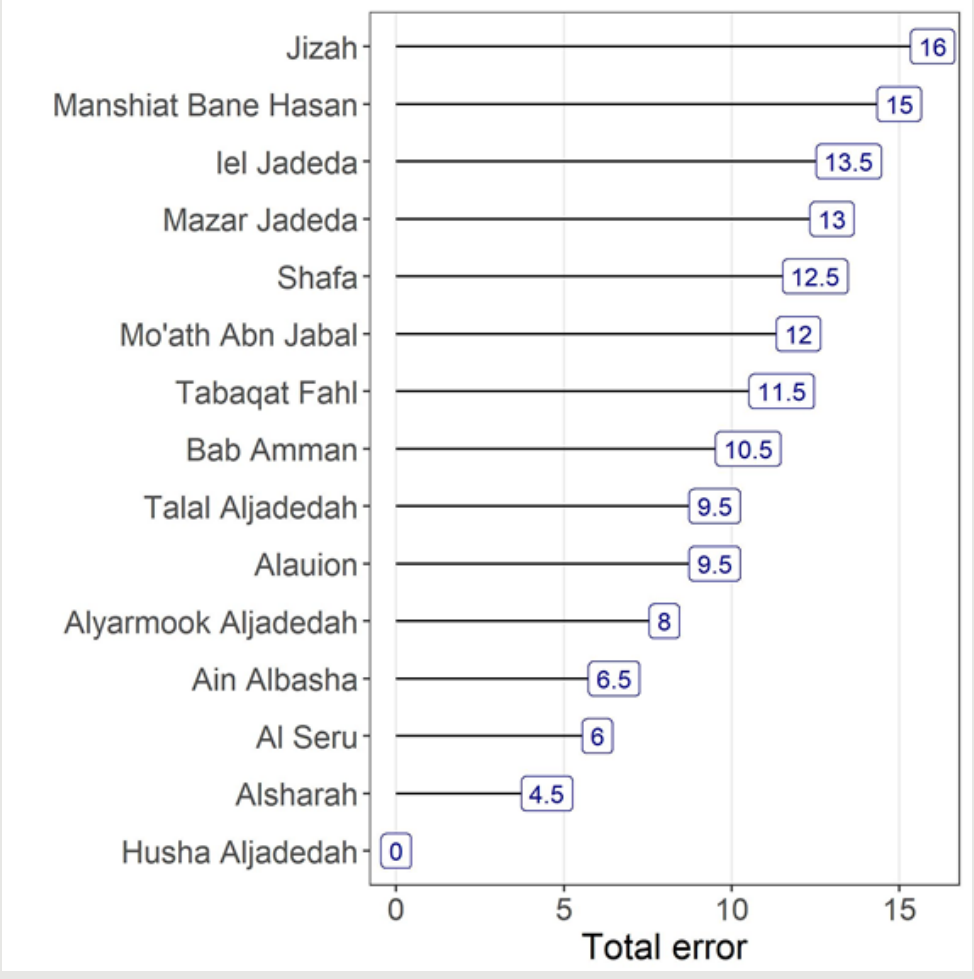
Perceptions of Decentralization

- Promising initiative but will take time to take root
- Assigned responsibilities to inexperienced actors
- Centralized decision-making is still operative
- Weak engagement and linkages between layers
- Heightened citizens' expectations
- May have adversely affected local government's ability to address communal needs
- Need to activate municipalities' developmental role
- Exposed gaps in legal framework

MICA Scoring Process

- Data collection in 15 comparison municipalities (Feb-April)
  - 3 enumerators, independent notes and scores
- Facilitated enumerator scoring review
  - Rationale behind scores
  - Review of observations and notes
  - Review and discussion of scoring rubric challenges and interpretations
    - Any decisions on scoring practices reached by consensus
    - Scoring logic applied to other municipalities
  - Formulated final unified score for each MICA element in each municipality
- Reviewed scoring evaluation team scoring logic and any issue areas with CITIES Component 1 Leader

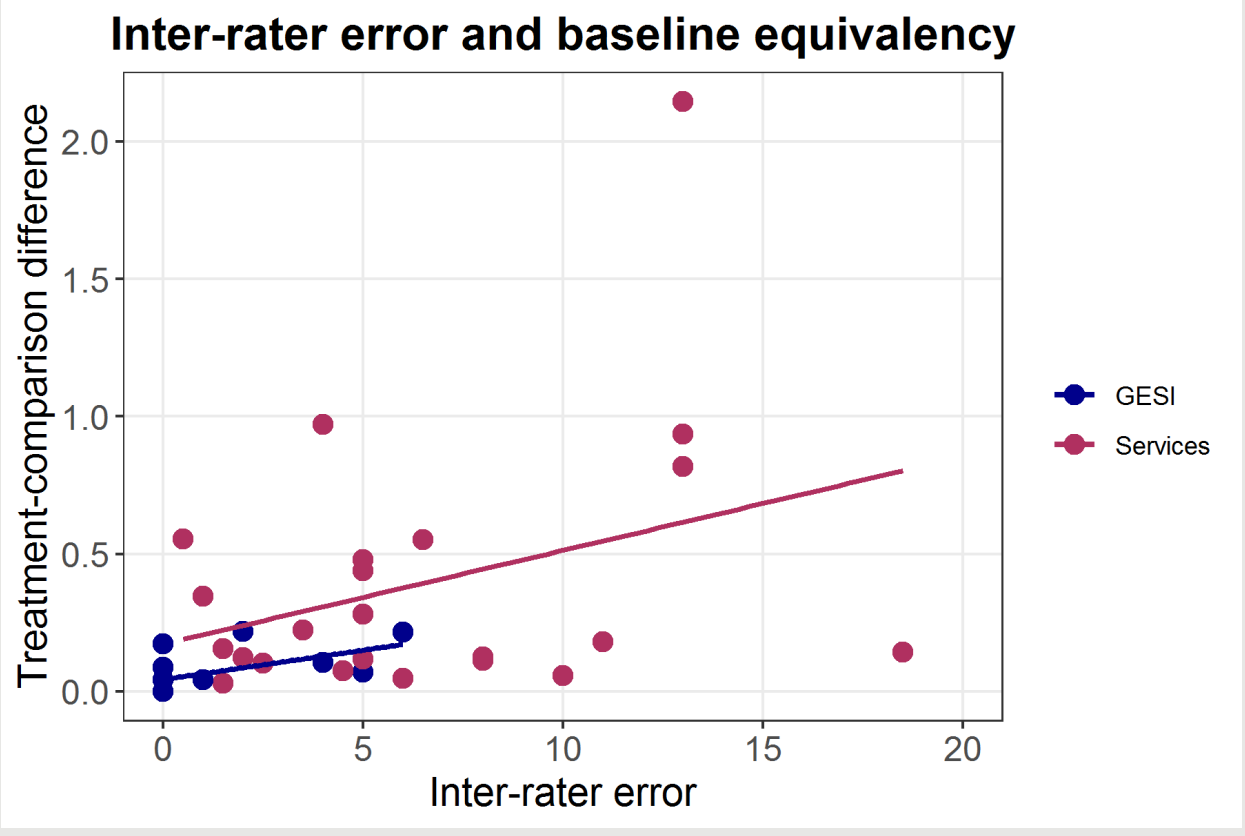
Total Inter-rater Error, by municipality



Most Inter-rater Error, by MICA Item

Item	Measure	Total Error
4.3	Waste Management	18.5
1.2	Records, Permitting, Licensing	13
4.7	Transportation	13
7.2	Disaster Management	13
3.1	Urban Planning	11
3.4	Building Licensing	10

- Higher inter-rater error leads to larger differences between treatment and comparison
- Scoring review with CITIES Component 1 addresses methodological discrepancies



Inter-rater agreement statistics

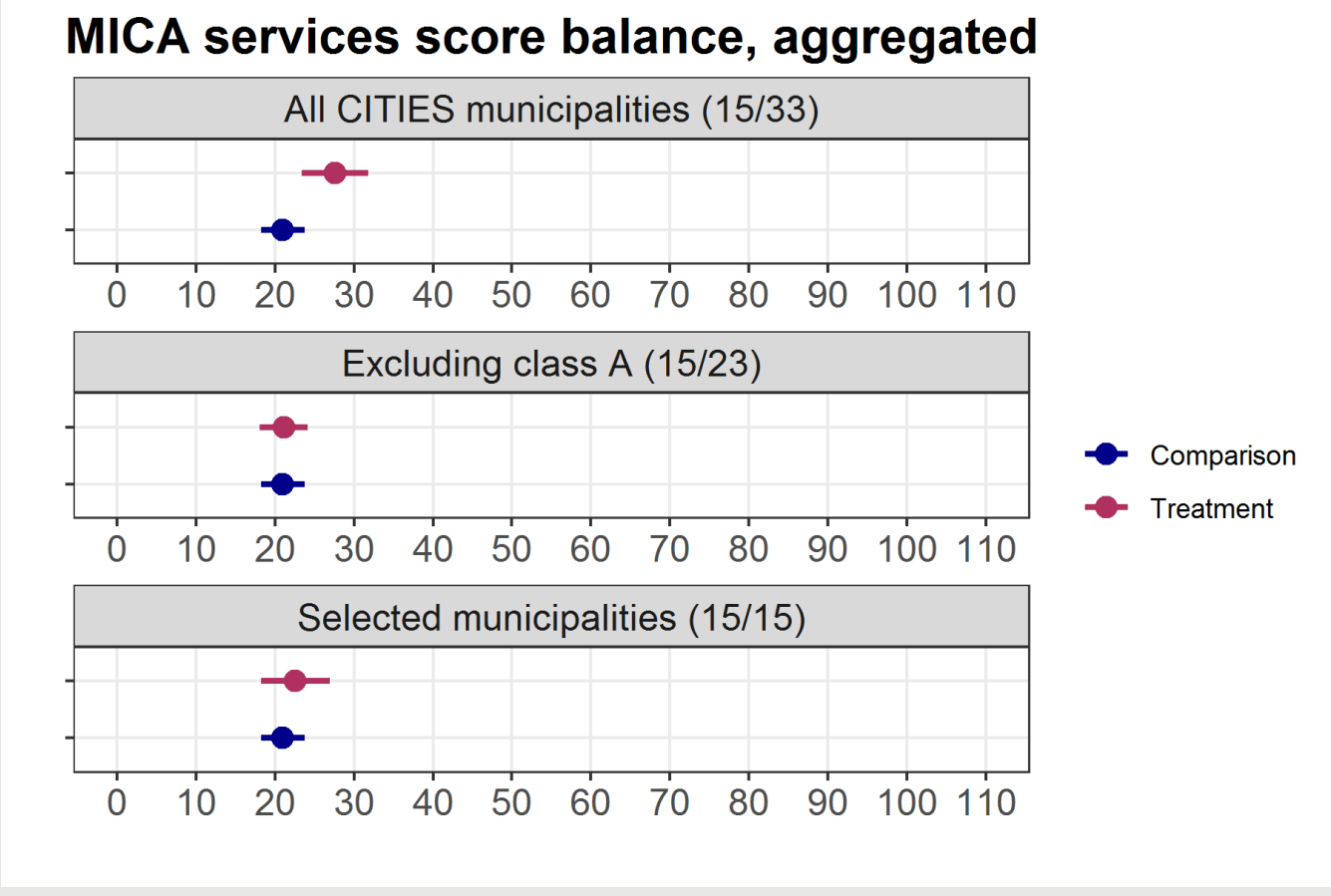
Municipality	Percent Agreement	Weighted Kappa Score
Alsharah	71	0.97
Al Seru	71	0.98
Talal Aljadedah	70	0.65
Mo'ath Abn Jabal	67	0.97
Bab Amman	67	0.63
Ain Albasha	67	0.98
Alauion	65	0.95
Manshiat Bane Hasan	64	0.64
Iel Jadeda	61	0.94
Tabaqat Fahl	60	0.96
Alyarmook Aljadedah	60	0.98
Shafa	57	0.57
Jizah	56	0.95
Mazar Jadeda	56	0.97

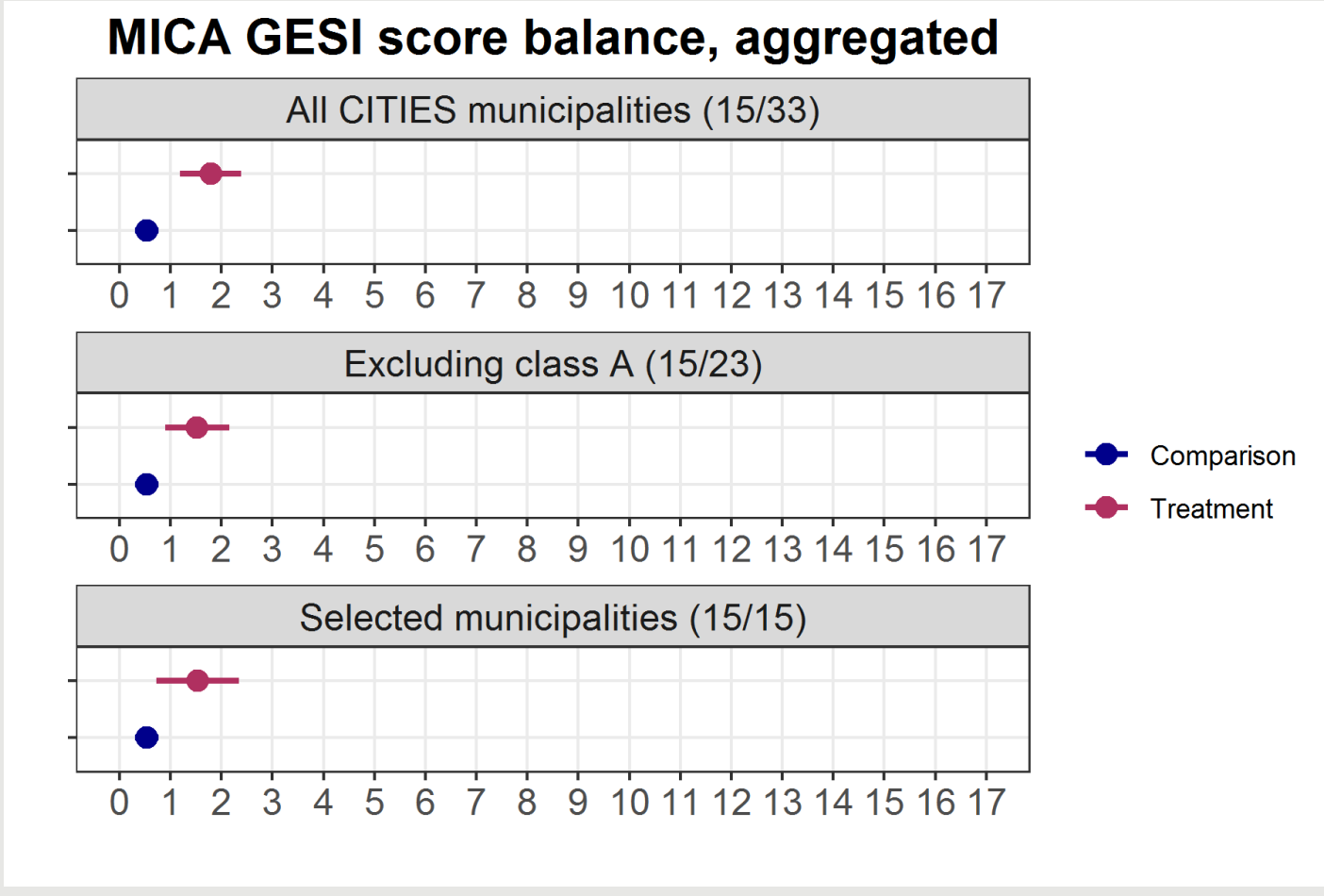
Internal Validity of Evaluation Team MICA Scores: Conclusion

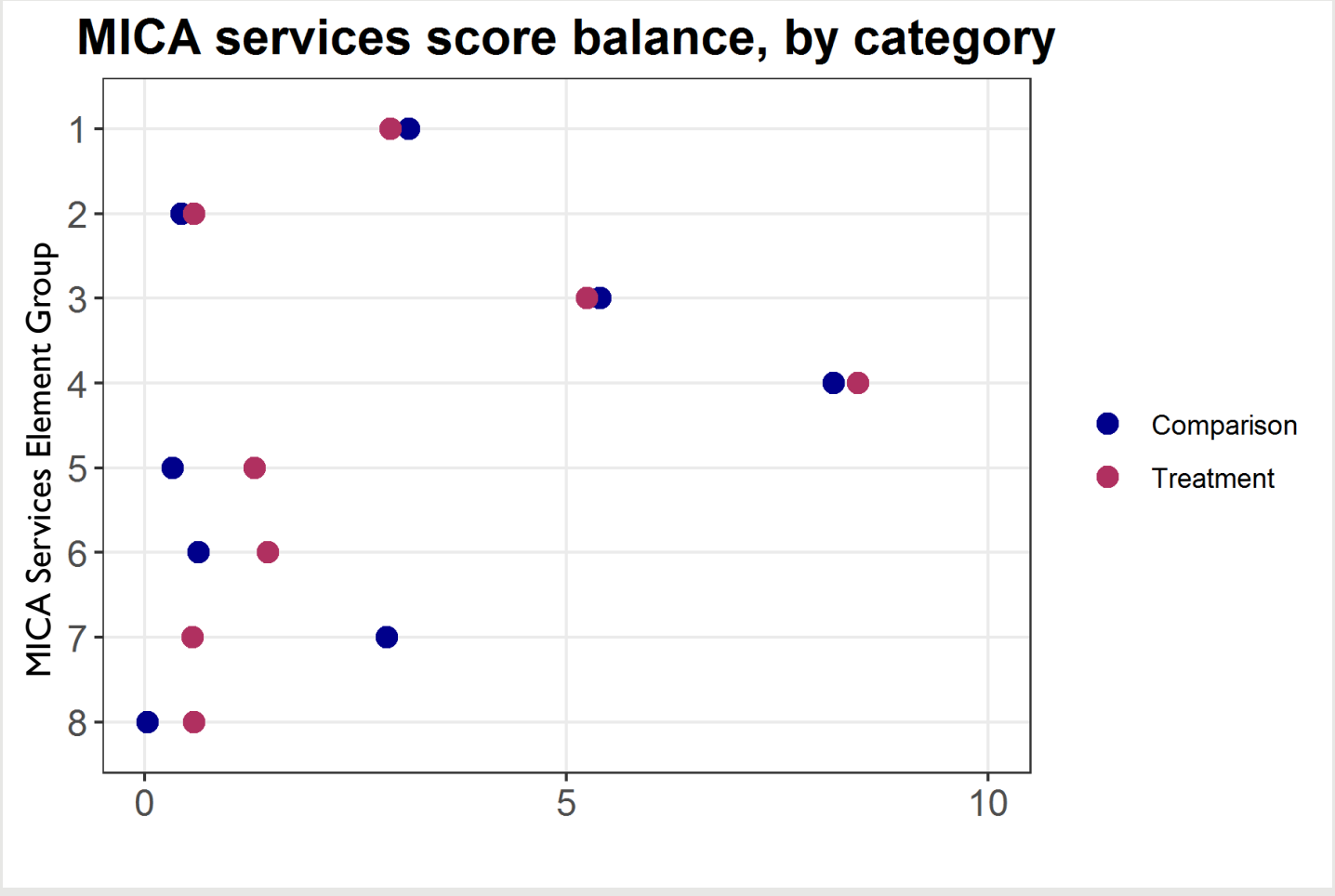
- Comparison MICA scores are internally valid among MESP raters and with CITIES scorers
  - A low to moderate correlation between inter-rater error and differences across treatment and comparison highlights the risk that inter-rater error can pose to impact estimates
  - Despite some concerns about a few items and municipalities, measures generally appear to have sufficient agreement between raters

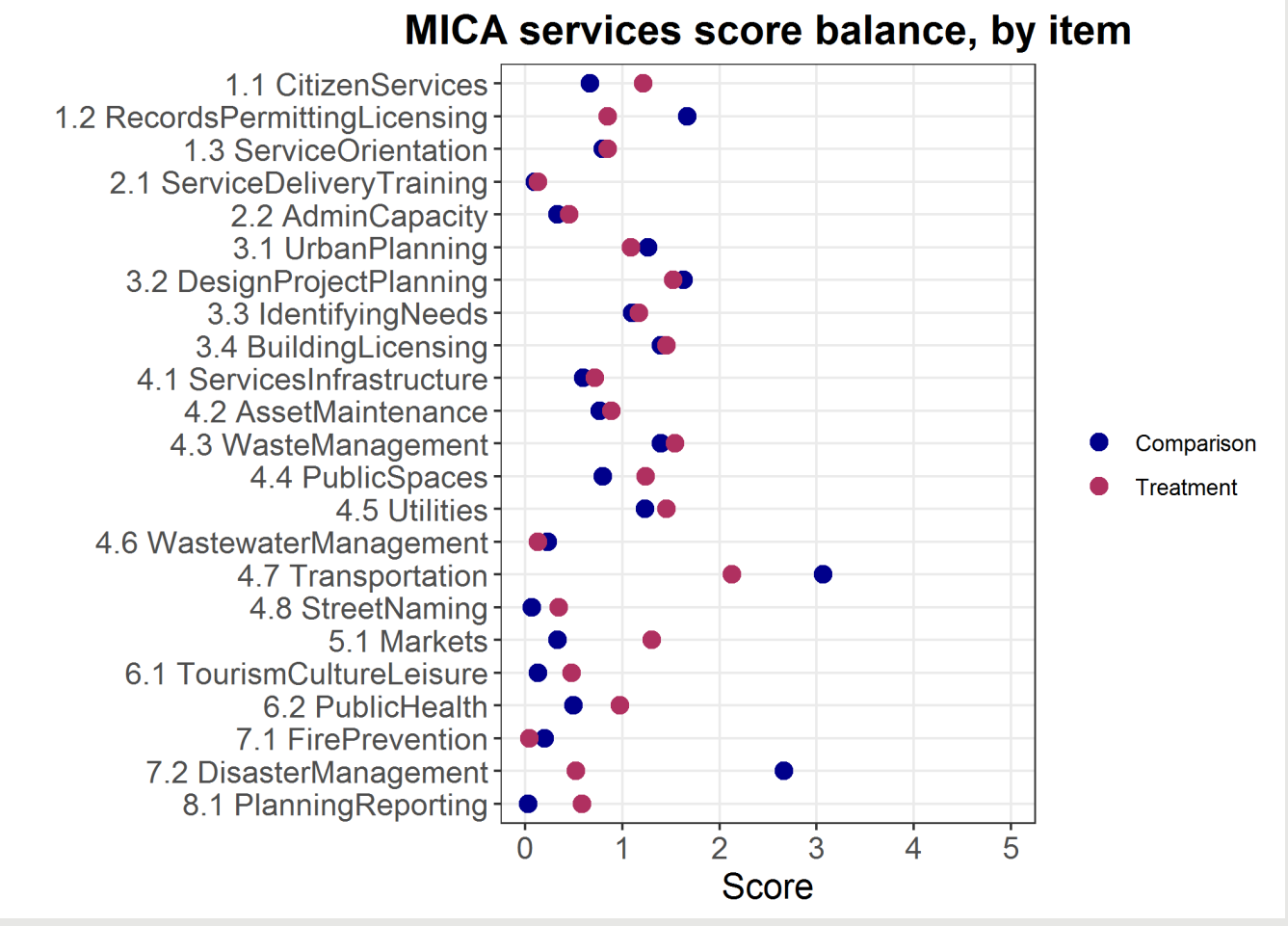
Baseline Equivalency of MICA Measures: Aggregated

Category (Treatment / Comparison)	Component	Treatment Mean	Comparison Mean	Difference	Standardized difference
Selected municipalities (15/15)	Services	22.6	21	1.6	0.25
Excluding class A (15/23)	**Services**	**21.1**	**21**	**0.1**	**0.02**
All CITIES municipalities (15/33)	Services	27.6	21	6.6	0.70
Selected municipalities (15/15)	GESI	1.53	0.53	1	0.98
Excluding class A (15/23)	GESI	1.52	0.533	0.99	0.91
All CITIES municipalities (15/33)	GESI	1.8	0.53	1.27	0.96

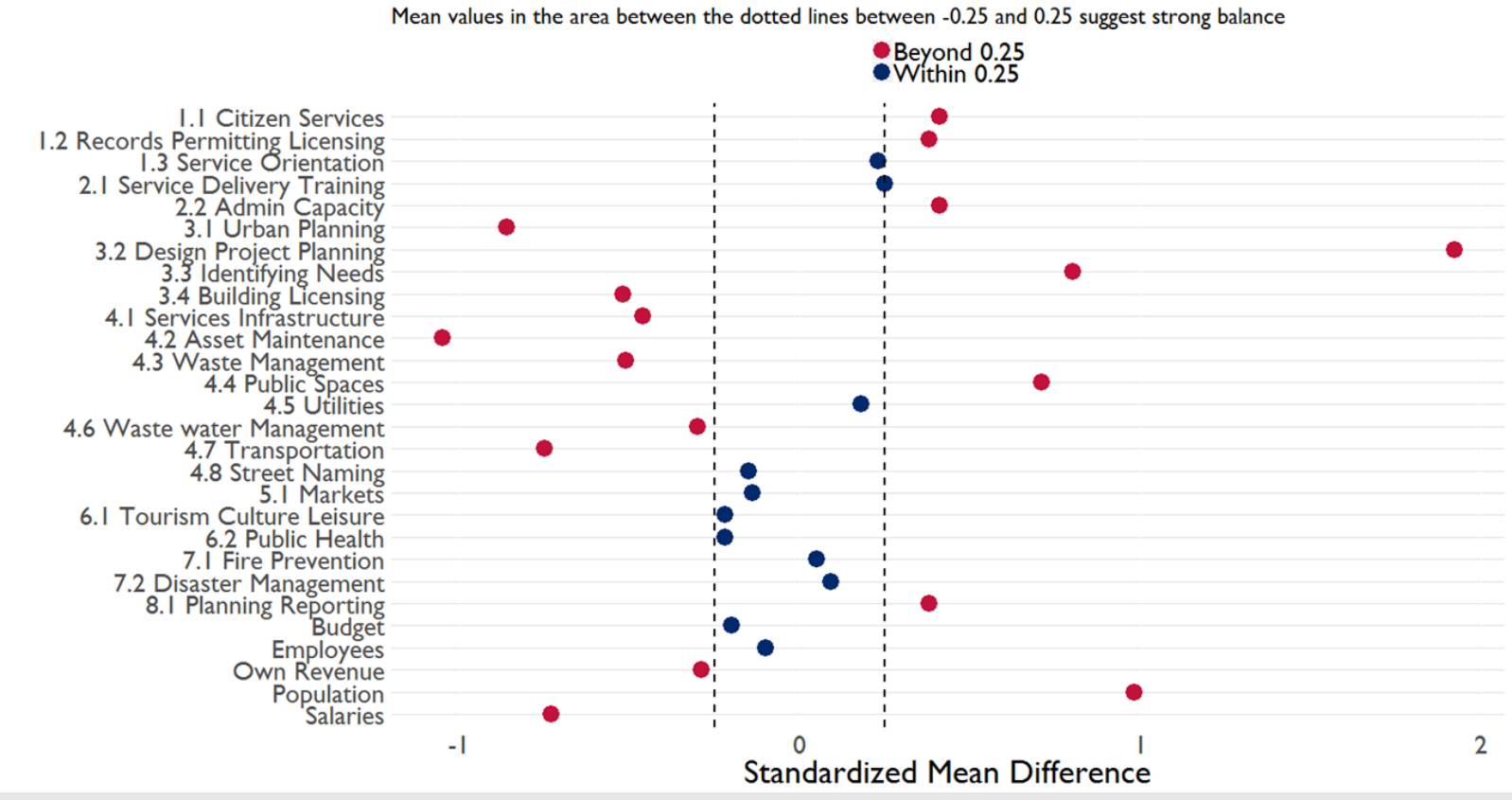

MICA services score balance, aggregated
All CITIES municipalities (15/33)
Excluding class A (15/23)
Selected municipalities (15/15)
0 10 20 30 40 50 60 70 80 90 100 110
Comparison
Treatment


MICA GESI score balance, aggregated
All CITIES municipalities (15/33)
Excluding class A (15/23)
Selected municipalities (15/15)
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17
Comparison
Treatment


MICA services score balance, by category
MICA Services Element Group
1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
0
5
10
Comparison
Treatment


MICA services score balance, by item
1.1 CitizenServices
1.2 RecordsPermittingLicensing
1.3 ServiceOrientation
2.1 ServiceDeliveryTraining
2.2 AdminCapacity
3.1 UrbanPlanning
3.2 DesignProjectPlanning
3.3 IdentifyingNeeds
3.4 BuildingLicensing
4.1 ServicesInfrastructure
4.2 AssetMaintenance
4.3 WasteManagement
4.4 PublicSpaces
4.5 Utilities
4.6 WastewaterManagement
4.7 Transportation
4.8 StreetNaming
5.1 Markets
6.1 TourismCultureLeisure
6.2 PublicHealth
7.1 FirePrevention
7.2 DisasterManagement
8.1 PlanningReporting
0
1
2
3
4
5
Score
Comparison
Treatment

Standardized Differences by Assessment Item – MICA Services



Baseline Equivalency Across Treatment and Comparison: Conclusions

- There is baseline equivalency across treatment and comparison municipalities
  - Despite some concerns about a few items and a few municipalities, in aggregate (scores aggregated to municipality or within scoring categories within municipalities) there appears to be baseline equivalency between treatment and comparison measures
  - Due to a higher degree of item-level variability, inference at the level of individual scoring items will require triangulation with other data streams

Evaluation Question 2: Sustainability

Findings from supplementary qualitative data collection

- System-level changes/initiatives endorsed by national government
- Capacity and will of MOMA and municipalities to assume and exercise ownership of program facilitated reforms
- Harmonized donor support for capacity development
- Civil society capable and empowered to monitor continued implementation of reforms and overall municipal performance
- Technical knowledge vs. awareness raising type of capacity building

Evaluation Question 2: Sustainability

- Overall risks to sustainability
  - GOJ slow implementation of reforms or devolution of power needed for municipalities to assume new responsibilities
  - Slow or inadequate provision of financial resources to municipalities or governorates
  - Serious municipal capacity constraints to sustain intervention benefits
  - Lack of incentives and weak motivation deter municipal staff participation and the adoption of corrective actions
  - Duplicative and unharmonized donor programming lead to municipal staff adopting different procedures and processes to undertake same tasks
  - Skewed public perception of municipal services affects program impact

Evaluation Question 3: Synergy

Findings from supplementary inquiry and donor tracking

- 28 implementing agencies operating through 48 projects that translate into 208 separate interventions at both the central and local levels and in the following areas:
  - Policy, Legislation and Regulation
  - Functional Assignment
  - Institutional and Organizational Structures
  - Inter-Governmental (Institutional)
  - Systems, Procedures and Manuals
  - Capacity Development
  - Local Public Finance

Evaluation Question 3: Synergy

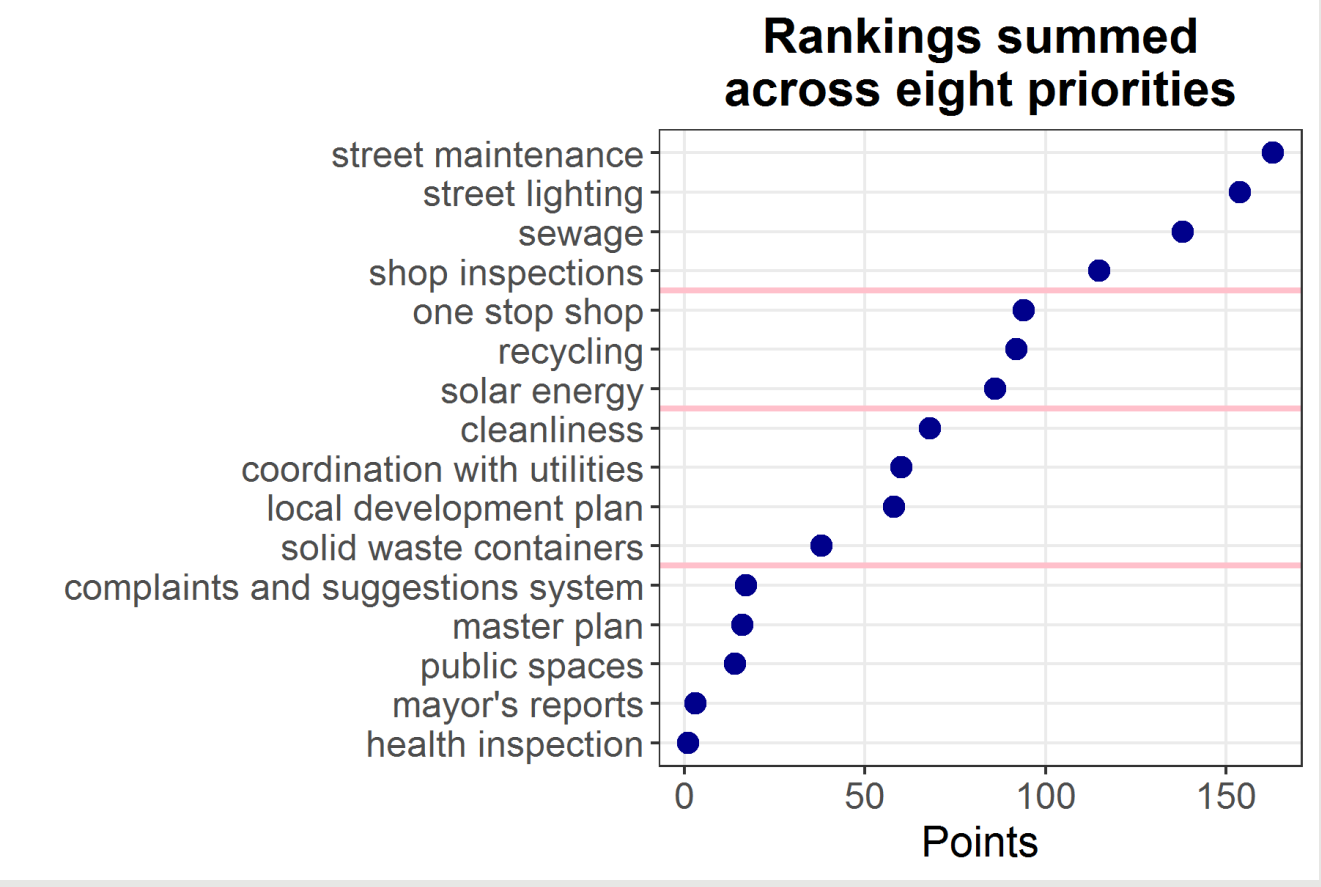
- Various donors implementing direct and indirect capacity building interventions
- A clear roadmap for envisioned change is still lacking
- Need for joint approach to maximize impact of programming
- Coordination lead by GOJ is more about communicating activities than working out division of donor efforts or synergies
- Weak horizontal coordination and linkages between MOMA staff overseeing projects
- Close coordination by CITIES with WB, OECD, VNG, AECID, and AFD

Evaluation Question 4: Learning

Information to track to inform understanding of context:

- Changes in legislative and regulatory framework
- Regulatory, relational and technical dimensions of the various municipal functions.
- Relational dynamics between municipal leadership staff
- Automation process in municipalities
- GOJ decision-making regarding resource allocation to municipalities and governorates
- Overall direction of decentralization
- Donor activities and lessons learned
- Traction on GoJ Local Governance Training Institute and the National Strategy of Decentralization

Component 1 Priorities



Tentative Projections of MICA Score Gains

For discussion purposes only – NOT official targets

(Source: Component 1 Lead discussion)

Section	Item	Measure	Type	Min	Max
1	1.1	CitizenServices	Services	0	0
1	1.2	RecordsPermittingLicensing	Services	0	0
1	1.3	ServiceOrientation	Services	0	0
2	2.1	ServiceDeliveryTraining	Services	0	0
2	2.2	AdminCapacity	Services	0	0
3	3.1	UrbanPlanning	Services	0	0
3	**3.2**	**DesignProjectPlanning**	**Services**	**0.5**	**1**
3	3.3	IdentifyingNeeds	Services	0	0
3	3.4	BuildingLicensing	Services	0	0
4	**4.1**	**ServicesInfrastructure**	**Services**	**0.5**	**1**
4	4.2	AssetMaintenance	Services	0	0
4	**4.3**	**WasteManagement**	**Services**	**0.5**	**1**
4	**4.4**	**PublicSpaces**	**Services**	**0.5**	**1**
4	4.5	Utilities	Services	0	0
4	4.6	WastewaterManagement	Services	0	0
4	4.7	Transportation	Services	0	0
4	**4.8**	**StreetNaming**	**Services**	**1**	**1**
5	**5.1**	**Markets**	**Services**	**0.5**	**0.5**
6	6.1	TourismCultureLeisure	Services	0	0
6	**6.2**	**PublicHealth**	**Services**	**0.5**	**0.5**
7	7.1	FirePrevention	Services	0	0
7	7.2	DisasterManagement	Services	0	0
8	**8.1**	**PlanningReporting**	**Services**	**1**	**1**
			Improvement:	5	7
			Percentage:	4.30%	6.10%
			Percent gain:	24%	33%

Threats to cohesion

Threat	Threat type	Municipalities
Drugs	Youth	20
Unemployment and Unutilized free time of youth	Youth	18
Elections & related tribal preference	Social related	16
Lack of parks and playgrounds /lack of youth facilities	Municipal services	15
Poverty & Unemployment	Social related	14
Arbitrary building and conflicts over land boundaries (lack of masterplans /Zoning)	Municipal services	11
Solid Waste: Garbage collection/ location of garbage containers/garbage compilation on streets	Municipal services	11
Syrian Influx	Social related	11
Inequitable service distribution by the municipality/weak service provision	Municipal services	10
Stray dogs	Municipal services	10
Moderate sense of responsibility towards the community	Social related	10

Opportunities to Evaluate CITIES Grants

- Grants in several sectors would not be expected to translate to improved public perception
- Opportunities to examine grants in relation to both institutional capacity and public perception include:
  - Street maintenance, cleanliness, lighting
  - Solid waste
  - Public parks

Final Thoughts and Next Steps

- Pending baseline analyses
- Future evaluation activities

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Pending Baseline Analyses to be Completed: Household Survey

- Household survey of n=12,000 launched in July, expected completion by September
- Originally motivated by desire to measure CITIES indicators on public perception, but also serves as a measurement and assessment tool for other mission indicators and activities as relevant
  - Analysis plan includes a learning agenda to pursue contextual questions around CITIES and other mission activities
- Analysis will extract CITIES-related indicators across a selection of treatment and comparison indicators
  - Analysis will examine baseline indicator levels as well as any differences between treatment and comparison municipalities
- Timeline for completion: Sep-Oct

Household Survey: Sampling

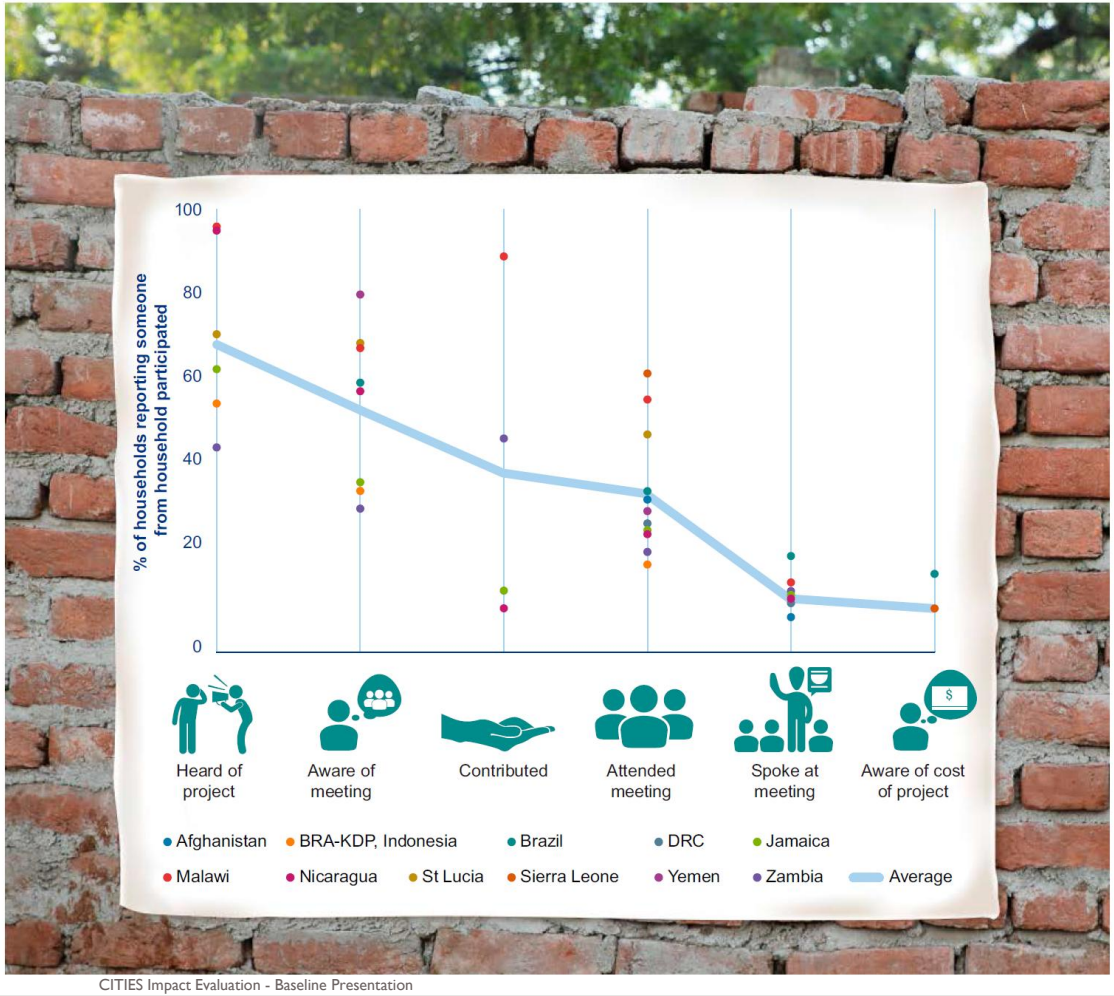
	Overall	A	B	C	D
Treatment	4,470	3,130	460	880	
Comparison	7,530	1,540	3,660	1,730	600

- 16 CITIES, 39 comparison municipalities
- 10 of the comparison municipalities have MICA (n=1,600)
- CITIES data mostly Class A municipalities

What to measure?

- Mission indicators
- Learning Agenda questions
- The 'funnel of attribution'

The ‘funnel of attribution’ will be used to discriminate between direct, indirect, and non-beneficiaries within CITIES municipalities



Source:

Community Driven Development: Does it build social cohesion or infrastructure?

3ie Working Paper #30

White, Menon, Waddington

Future Evaluation Activities for USAID Consideration

- FY 2018 Q4: next round of implementation fidelity monitoring
- FY 2019: small scale surveys targeting grant activities
- FY 2020 Q1: Midline evaluation covering CITIES Years 1-3
  - Most significant change / Appreciative inquiry
  - Investigate Learning Agenda questions
  - Evaluate the implementation of CITIES Year 3 activities and grants
- FY 2021 Q1: Endline evaluation activities
  - MICA scoring
  - Endline household survey
  - Investigate Learning Agenda questions


THANK YOU!
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